

RESOLUTION OF RIGHTS PROCEDURE

Having reviewed the complaint registered on November 22, 2023, with this Agency and having carried out the procedural actions provided for in Title VIII of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the following FACTS have been established:

FIRST: A.A.A. (hereinafter, the complainant) exercised the right of Erasure against TELEFÓNICA DE ESPAÑA, S.A.U. (hereinafter, the respondent) without receiving the legally established response to their request.

The complainant states that their personal data appears in Asnef at the request of the respondent, in relation to a debt they do not acknowledge and which is contested before the Arbitration Board, associated with the non-return of equipment, which they indicate was duly returned.

They also point out that the respondent did not previously request payment of the debt, nor were they notified of their inclusion by Asnef.

SECOND: In accordance with Article 65.4 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), this complaint was forwarded to the respondent for analysis and to inform this Agency within one month of the actions taken to comply with the requirements established in data protection regulations.

THIRD: The result of the transfer procedure indicated in the previous Fact did not allow for the satisfaction of the complainant's claims. Consequently, on February 22, 2024, for the purposes provided for in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection agreed to admit the complaint for processing.

The aforementioned agreement granted the respondent a hearing period, so that within ten working days they could present any arguments they deemed appropriate, summarizing the following arguments:

"The Complainant has not exercised any of the rights recognized in the GDPR through any of the channels enabled for this purpose, prior to the complaint filed with the Agency. That said, Telefónica, as stated in the aforementioned document, was unable to establish communication with the Complainant because they did not specify any means as a method of contact, nor an email for electronic communication, nor a postal address for sending a response by regular mail. Nevertheless, in light of the admission of the complaint and the communication received by Telefónica on March 11, 2024, we have proceeded to send a response letter from our DPO email address, which we attach as Annex 1 to this document, to the only channel we found possible to contact, the email used to contact our commercial brand Movistar."

FOURTH: After examining the document submitted by the respondent, it is forwarded to the complainant, so that, within ten working days, they may formulate any arguments they consider appropriate, without submitting arguments within the established period.

LEGAL GROUNDS

I

Competence

In accordance with the powers granted to each supervisory authority by Article 58.2 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and as established in Articles 47, 48.1, and 64.1 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection is competent to initiate and resolve this procedure.

Furthermore, Article 63.2 of the LOPDGDD states: "The procedures processed by the Spanish Agency for Data Protection shall be governed by the provisions of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, by this organic law, by the regulatory provisions issued in its development, and, in so far as they do not contradict them, subsidiarily by the general rules on administrative procedures."

II

Preliminary Issues

In accordance with the provisions of Article 55 of the GDPR, the Spanish Agency for Data Protection is competent to perform the functions assigned to it in Article 57, including the enforcement of the Regulation and promoting awareness among data controllers and processors regarding their obligations, as well as addressing complaints filed by a data subject and investigating, as appropriate, the reasons for such complaints.

Correspondingly, Article 31 of the GDPR establishes the obligation of data controllers and processors to cooperate with the supervisory authority that requests it in the performance of its functions. In cases where they have appointed a data protection officer, Article 39 of the GDPR assigns this officer the function of cooperating with that authority.

In accordance with this regulation, following the procedure provided for in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD, prior to the admission of the complaint...

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Exercise of the rights regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, which gives rise to the present procedure, was communicated to the party being claimed against so that they could analyze it, respond to this Agency within a month, and provide evidence of having given the claimant the appropriate response.

The result of this communication did not allow for the understanding that the claims of the claimant were satisfied. Consequently, on February 22, 2024, for the purposes provided in Articles 64.1 and 65 of the LOPDGDD, the complaint submitted was admitted for processing. This admission for processing determines the opening of the present procedure for the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, regulated in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, according to which:

“When the procedure refers exclusively to the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council, of April 27, 2016, it shall be initiated by an admission agreement, which shall be adopted in accordance with the provisions of Article 65 of this organic law.

In this case, the deadline for resolving the procedure shall be six months from the date on which the agreement of admission to processing was notified to the claimant. After this period, the interested party may consider their complaint accepted.”

Article 58.2 of the GDPR grants the Spanish Data Protection Agency a series of corrective powers for the purpose of correcting any infringement of the GDPR, including “ordering the data controller or processor to attend to the requests for the exercise of the rights of the data subject under this Regulation.”

III

Rights of individuals regarding personal data protection

The rights of individuals regarding personal data protection are regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR and Articles 13 to 18 of the LOPDGDD. The rights of access, rectification, deletion, opposition, the right to limit processing, and the right to data portability are contemplated.

The formal aspects related to the exercise of these rights are established in Articles 12 of the GDPR and 12 of the LOPDGDD.

Additionally, consideration is given to what is expressed in Recitals 59 and following of the GDPR.

In accordance with the provisions of these regulations, the data controller must establish formulas and mechanisms to facilitate the exercise of their rights by the data subject, which shall be free of charge (without prejudice to the provisions of Articles 12.5 and 15.3 of the GDPR), and is obliged to respond to requests made no later than one month, unless they can demonstrate that they are unable to identify the data subject, and to express their reasons in case they do not intend to attend to such request.

request. The burden of proof regarding compliance with the duty to respond to the request for the exercise of rights made by the affected party falls on the responsible party.

The communication addressed to the interested party regarding their request must be expressed in a concise, transparent, intelligible, and easily accessible manner, using clear and simple language.

IV

Right to Erasure

Article 17 of the GDPR, which regulates the right to erasure of personal data, establishes the following:

"1. The data subject shall have the right to obtain from the data controller the erasure of personal data concerning them without undue delay, and the data controller shall be obliged to erase personal data without undue delay when one of the following circumstances applies:

- a) the personal data are no longer necessary in relation to the purposes for which they were collected or otherwise processed;
- b) the data subject withdraws consent on which the processing is based in accordance with Article 6(1)(a) or Article 9(2)(a), and where there is no other legal ground for the processing;
- c) the data subject objects to the processing pursuant to Article 21(1), and there are no overriding legitimate grounds for the processing, or the data subject objects to the processing pursuant to Article 21(2);
- d) the personal data have been unlawfully processed;
- e) the personal data must be erased for compliance with a legal obligation in Union or Member State law to which the data controller is subject;
- f) the personal data have been collected in relation to the offer of information society services referred to in Article 8(1).

2. Where the data controller has made the personal data public and is obliged, under paragraph 1, to erase such data, the data controller, taking into account the available technology and the cost of implementation, shall take reasonable steps, including technical measures, to inform controllers that are processing the personal data of the data subject's request for erasure of any links to, or copies or replications of, those personal data.

3. Paragraphs 1 and 2 shall not apply to the extent that processing is necessary:

- a) for exercising the right of freedom of expression and information;
- b) for compliance with a legal obligation which requires processing by Union or Member State law to which the data controller is subject, or for the performance of a task carried out in the public interest or in the exercise of official authority vested in the controller;
- c) for reasons of public interest in the area of public health in accordance with Article 9(2)(h) and (i), and paragraph 3;

- d) for archiving purposes in the public interest, for scientific or historical research purposes, or for statistical purposes, in accordance with Article 89, paragraph 1, to the extent that the right indicated in paragraph 1 could make it impossible or seriously hinder the achievement of the objectives of such processing, or

- e) for the formulation, exercise, or defense of claims."

V

Conclusion

We will begin by stating that this claim will only consider whether the requested right, the right to

erasure, has been addressed or not. The other issues raised by the parties, their discrepancies, disagreements, etc., must be resolved outside of this resolution.

In the case analyzed here, the claiming party exercised their right to erasure and, after the period established in the aforementioned regulations, their request did not receive the legally required response, as access was not provided as requested.

The aforementioned regulations do not allow the request to be overlooked as if it had not been made, leaving it without the response that the responsible parties are obliged to issue, even in the event that there are no data of the interested party in the entity's files or even in those cases where the requirements set forth are not met, in which case the recipient of such a request is also obliged to require the correction of the observed deficiencies or, if applicable, deny the request with reasons indicating the causes for which the right in question should not be considered.

Therefore, the request made obliges the responsible party to provide an express response, in any case, using any means that justifies the receipt of the response.

In this case, however, it is noted that during the processing of the claim that gives rise to this procedure, formulated precisely due to the lack of an adequate response to the request for the exercise of rights, the responding party has provided documentation proving the communication sent to the interested party addressing the right or informing about the decision made regarding the request. This response, therefore, occurs after the established deadline has passed.

In this regard, it should be clarified that the response that corresponds to be made cannot be expressed merely as part of an administrative procedure. Consequently, considering that this procedure aims to ensure that the guarantees and rights of the affected parties are duly restored, combining the information in the file with the regulations referred to in the preceding paragraphs, it is appropriate to uphold this claim on formal grounds due to the response being issued late, without requiring the responsible party to carry out additional actions in order to issue a new certification regarding the attention to the right.

In light of the cited provisions and others of general application, the Director of the Spanish Data Protection Agency RESOLVES:

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FIRST: TO UPHOLD on formal grounds, the claim made by A.A.A., against TELEFÓNICA DE ESPAÑA, S.A.U. However, it is not appropriate to issue a new certification by the responding party, as the response was issued late, without requiring the responsible party to carry out additional actions.

SECOND: TO NOTIFY this resolution to A.A.A. and to TELEFÓNICA DE ESPAÑA, S.A.U.

In accordance with the provisions of Article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative procedure in accordance with Article 48.6 of the LOPDGDD, and in accordance with the provisions of Article 123 of the LPACAP, the interested parties may optionally file a motion for reconsideration before the Director of the Spanish Data Protection Agency within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution or directly file a contentious-administrative appeal before the Contentious-Administrative Chamber of the National Court, in accordance with the provisions of Article 25 and paragraph 5 of the fourth additional provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating the Contentious-Administrative Jurisdiction, within two months from the day following the notification of this act, as provided in Article 46.1 of the aforementioned Law.

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